



Tenka Fubu

Total War: Shogun 2

Modlist & Guide

For the latest Steam version (patch 1.1.0, build 5934)

Three waves — three campaigns — one sword

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Wave 0: The Shimazu Way

Installation & Setup

This guide assumes a clean installation of Total War: SHOGUN 2 via Steam with no previous modifications.

Verifying Your Game Version

Open your Steam Library, right-click **Total War: SHOGUN 2**, select **Properties**, go to the **Installed Files** tab. Verify the game is on the latest version (which is auto-updated by Steam). The final build is patch 1.1.0, build 5934 (September 2013).

No Mods Required

Wave 0 is played on a completely vanilla game. Do NOT subscribe to any mods before starting this wave. The purpose of this wave is to learn the game's core systems from a clean state.

If you already have mods subscribed, unsubscribe from all of them before proceeding:

1. Open Steam Workshop for Shogun 2
2. "Your Files" → "Subscribed Items"
3. Unsubscribe from everything
4. Verify

```
%appdata%/The Creative Assembly/Shogun2/scripts/user.script.txt
```

is empty or does not exist

5. Delete any

```
.pack
```

files in

```
steamapps/common/Total War Shogun 2/data/
```

that are not part of the base game

Launching the Game

1. Launch **Total War: SHOGUN 2** from Steam
2. The **Total War: Launcher** will appear
3. The mod list should be empty (no mods checked on)
4. Click **Play**

Starting a New Campaign

From the main menu:

1. Select **Single Player** → **New Campaign**
2. Select the **Shimazu** clan
3. Choose **Normal** difficulty (this is the intended experience for Wave 0)

4. Set Campaign length to **Short** for your first run
5. Leave all other settings at default
6. Click **Start**

First Loading Screen Tips

- Pay attention to the loading screen tips — they teach real mechanics
- The advisor (the floating face) can be toggled off with the top-left button, but keep it on for Wave 0
- Pause the game with

P

anytime during a battle

Saving and Loading

- The game auto-saves at the start of each turn
- Manual saves are recommended before any major battle (use

F5

for quick save)

- You can have multiple save files — rotate them so you can go back if needed

Wave 0: Mod List

This wave uses no gameplay-altering mods. The following are approved UI and quality-of-life improvements that do not change game mechanics.

Recommended UI / QoL Mods

None listed yet. Mods will be added when the modlist is finalized.

What NOT to Install

For Wave 0, avoid any mod that:

- Changes unit stats or recruitment
- Alters the campaign map
- Adds new units or buildings
- Modifies AI behavior
- Changes any game balance values

The purpose of Wave 0 is to learn the game as designed. Save the modifications for later waves.

How to Play: Total War: SHOGUN 2

New Player Training Path

This guide teaches you the basics through your first 15 hours. Do not try to conquer Japan on your first campaign. Your goal is to learn how the game works, then restart with that knowledge.

Phase 0: The Tutorial (30 Minutes)

Launch the in-game tutorial from the main menu. Do not skip it. Shogun 2 has unique controls not found in other strategy games:

- Space

pauses the game. While paused, issue orders to every unit. This is how you win battles — by giving every unit a job before unpausing.

- Alt

+ drag selects a formation width. Use this to set your battle line exactly where you want it.

- Backspace

or

K

orders a unit to disengage from melee. They will take casualties while pulling back, but less than if they break and rout.

- Insert

toggles advanced unit info. Turn this on and leave it on — it shows current health, fatigue, and morale for selected units.

- Tab

cycles through units in the current group.

- Shift

+ click adds waypoints to a movement order. Use this to set up flanking routes before combat.

After the tutorial, play the historical battle **Battle of Okehazama** on Normal. This battle teaches the most important lesson in Shogun 2: a smaller army can destroy a larger one by attacking from the correct direction at the correct time.

Phase 1: Campaign Fundamentals (Hours 1–15)

Start as **Shimazu** on Normal difficulty with Short campaign length. Set battle timer to Unlimited. Set unit size to Large or Ultra.

Your first 15 hours are about one thing: the **economy loop**. Everything else depends on it.

— The Economy Loop —

Every province produces food, wealth, and population growth. These three numbers determine everything you can do:

Food: Each castle tier consumes a fixed amount of food (tier 1 = 2 food, tier 2 = 4 food, tier 3 = 6 food). Armies on the campaign map consume 1 food per army per turn. You see your food total in the top bar. Positive surplus gives +2 happiness in every province. Negative food causes -2 happiness per missing point, leading to rebellions.

Wealth: The total taxable value of a province. Tax rate (Low, Normal, High, Very High) multiplies this into your treasury. A province with 1000 wealth at Normal tax gives 300 koku per turn. Build markets and trade ports to increase wealth.

Growth: Population changes each turn based on food surplus, tax rate, and buildings. More population increases the province's wealth baseline. Farms are your primary growth engine. A province with +4 growth will double its wealth-producing population in roughly 20 turns.

The loop: build farms → food surplus increases growth → population grows → wealth increases → tax income rises → you afford more armies → you conquer more provinces with more farm slots.

—- Turn Structure —-

Every turn, in this order:

1. Check the top bar: is food positive? Is money positive?
2. Look at each province: is happiness above 70%? If not, fix it before building anything.
3. Build one thing per province that needs attention.
4. Recruit units in provinces with castles.
5. Move armies and agents.
6. End turn. Watch the AI turn for notifications (battles, events, agent actions).

—- Building Chains —-

Each province has 4-6 building slots depending on whether it is coastal. Every slot belongs to a specific category. You cannot build two buildings in the same category in one province.

The building categories and their upgrade paths:

Castle (military): Stronghold → Fortress → Citadel → Fortress of the First Rank. Each tier unlocks higher-tier units: tier 2 unlocks samurai spear and bow, tier 3 unlocks katana samurai and cavalry dojo upgrades, tier 4 unlocks matchlock units. Each tier also consumes +2 food and adds garrison units that appear when the province is besieged. **Build this when you need better troops, not before.**

Farm (food): Rice Paddies → Terraced Fields → Irrigation Ditches. Each upgrade increases food output and growth rate. Max tier farms produce 6-8 food. **Build this first in every province.**

Market (wealth): Local Market → Merchant Guild → Merchant Conclave. Each tier adds wealth and trade income. The top tier adds a significant faction-wide trade bonus. **Build this second after the farm.**

Temple (order/religion): Shinto Shrine → Grand Shrine. Increases happiness and converts province to your starting religion (Shinto for most clans, Christian if you convert). A province following your state religion gets +3 happiness. A province following a different religion gets -3 to -8 happiness depending on how many religions are present.

Port (trade/navy — coastal only): Fishing Village → Commercial Port → Military Port. Generates trade income and allows naval recruitment. Military ports unlock stronger warships.

Road (logistics): Unexplored Tracks → Well-Kept Road. Increases army movement speed within the province. Build on border provinces to react faster to invasions.

Sake Den (happiness/income — some provinces): Generates moderate wealth and small happiness bonus. The upgraded version adds larger wealth but causes a small public order penalty. Only build in provinces with excess happiness.

Library (research): Modest study → Scholar Dojo. Increases research rate for both military and civil technologies. Expensive but valuable in a long campaign. Build one dedicated library province.

— Tax Rates and Honor —

Your tax rate sets the percentage of wealth collected each turn:

- **Low:** +1 happiness, reduced income. Use during rebellions.
- **Normal:** Default. Balanced income.
- **High:** +20% income, -2 happiness.
- **Very High:** +40% income, -5 happiness, growth penalty.

Honor: Your clan's honor level (0-6) affects diplomacy acceptance rates and agent success chances. Breaking treaties, attacking allies, and using underhanded tactics reduces honor. Honorable actions (sparing defeated enemies, honoring alliances, granting safe passage) increase honor. Keep honor at 3+ for functional diplomacy.

— Army Composition for the First Campaign —

Your first army should be:

Core (6 units): Yari Ashigaru. They are cheap, fast to recruit, and their **yari wall** formation is the strongest defensive formation in the game. A yari wall gives +15 bonus against cavalry, negates charge bonus, and adds mass (units cannot push through). Form yari wall by selecting the unit and clicking the wall button or pressing

B

.

Missile (4 units): Bow Ashigaru. They are fragile but cheap. Keep them behind the yari wall. Turn off **fire at will** (press F) until the enemy enters range, then turn it on to preserve ammunition. Wait until the enemy is at 150 units distance before shooting.

Flank (2 units): Yari Cavalry. You do not have a cavalry dojo yet, so these come from the basic recruitment pool. They are weak in a frontal charge but deadly from the rear. Charge (press

R

) into the back of an engaged enemy unit. The charge bonus + morale penalty from being hit in the rear will route most units instantly.

Total: 12 units. This fits under your general's command limit (16 units at rank 1) and costs roughly 800 koku per turn to maintain.

Do NOT recruit samurai in your first 20 turns. They cost 2-3x more than ashigaru, take 2 turns to recruit, and require castle upgrades you cannot afford yet.

—- Combat Mechanics —-

Shogun 2's battle system is driven by four hidden numbers:

Morale: Every unit has a morale value (ashigaru: 6-8, samurai: 10-16, elite: 18-22). Morale damage comes from: taking casualties (biggest factor), being flanked (-8), having the general killed (-12 to all units), being hit in the rear (-8), being charged by cavalry (-4), taking fire without being able to return it (-2 per volley). When morale hits 0, the unit routs. Routing units that are chased off the battlefield are permanently destroyed.

Fatigue: Units have four fatigue states: fresh → active → tired → exhausted. Exhausted units fight at 50% effectiveness, rout faster, and move slower. Running, fighting, climbing walls, and wading through rivers causes fatigue. Walking and standing restores it. **March your armies to the battlefield, do not run them.**

Armor and Attack: Each unit has melee attack (chance to hit), melee defense (chance to block), armor (damage reduction), and weapon damage. A katana samurai has 12 attack, 10 defense, 6 armor, and 12 damage. A yari ashigaru has 4 attack, 4 defense, 3 armor, and 7 damage. The samurai wins in a straight fight — but the ashigaru costs half as much and gets yari wall.

Charge Bonus: Cavalry and shock infantry get a charge bonus added to their attack on the first hit. Yari cavalry have 15 charge bonus. This is why cavalry cycles out of combat and recharges — the second charge gets the bonus again.

—- Your First Battle: Step by Step —-

1. Before the battle starts, deploy your army. Click and drag to set formation width. Put yari in front, bows behind, cavalry on a flank.
2. Once deployed, pause (Space). Give movement orders to every unit so they advance in formation.
3. Unpause. The armies approach. Your bow units will start shooting automatically. Let them.
4. When the enemy infantry is 50 units from your line, pause again. Order your cavalry to move wide around the enemy flank — outside the enemy's visible range if possible.
5. Unpause. The lines clash. Watch the yari wall icon — it needs to be active.
6. While the lines are engaged, pause. Order your cavalry to charge the rear of an enemy unit that is already fighting your yari. Use the charge ability (R) from about 150 units distance.
7. That enemy unit will rout almost instantly. Your cavalry bounces out of combat (they auto-disengage after a charge). Order them to charge the next engaged enemy unit in the rear.
8. Repeat step 7 until the enemy line breaks. Once 2-3 units rout, nearby units start checking their own morale and often rout too — a chain rout.

This tactic (yari wall + cavalry flanking) wins 90% of your battles for the entire early and mid game.

Your First 10 Turns: Walkthrough

Turn 1: Open Satsuma province. Build a Farm upgrade (costs 600 koku, takes 2 turns). Recruit 2 yari ashigaru (costs 300 koku, takes 1 turn). Move your general's army northeast toward the Ito border. End turn.

Turn 2: Farm completes. Build a Market in Satsuma (400 koku, 2 turns). Recruit 2 more yari ashigaru. Move army to the border with Ito. End turn.

Turn 3: Market completes. Recruit 2 bow ashigaru. Move into Ito territory. The Ito may attack you — if they do, fight manually. Auto-resolve favors the AI at the start of the game. If they do not attack, move next to their castle and begin a siege. Build a siege tower (2 turns to build). While building, your army blocks all movement out of the castle.

Turn 4: Keep building the siege tower. Recruit 1 more yari ashigaru in Satsuma. Check happiness — if below 70%, reduce tax rate to Low for one turn.

Turn 5: Siege tower completes. Attack the castle. Deploy your army: yari in front, bows behind. The siege tower automatically moves to the wall when you click on it. Your troops climb and fight on the walls. The defender gets a combat bonus on walls, so send 2-3 units per tower. Once you control one wall section, send infantry through to capture the center.

Turns 6-8: Capture Ito province. Build a Farm, then a Market. Recruit more ashigaru. Scout east toward Sagara territory. Do not declare war — let them attack you while you develop.

Turns 9-10: You now control two provinces. Stabilize happiness. Watch the food bar. If positive, build another farm or improve the castle. If negative, build a farm immediately. Save the game before your next war.

Victory Conditions

Short Campaign victory (Shimazu):

- Control 20 provinces (includes Kyushu island + southern Honshu)
- Survive Realm Divide
- Eliminate the 2 rival clans on your victory screen

You will trigger Realm Divide when you approach 25+ provinces. All surviving clans declare war on you at once. This is the final exam of every campaign. Surviving Realm Divide is covered in Wave 2's guide.

When to Move to Wave 1

You are ready to move forward when:

- You completed one campaign on Normal difficulty
- You understand which buildings to build in which order
- You can win basic battles using yari wall + cavalry without heavy losses
- You know what the three top-bar numbers (koku, food, honor) mean and how to adjust them

Start Wave 1 to learn army composition, agents, trade, and how to prepare for Realm Divide.

Wave 1: Tenka Fubu

Installation & Setup

Wave 1 introduces visual, unit, and faction mods. You must have completed at least one vanilla campaign before starting this wave.

Resetting user.script.txt

Before adding mods, clear your previous load order:

1. Navigate to

```
%appdata%/The Creative Assembly/Shogun2/scripts/
```

2. Open

```
user.script.txt
```

in Notepad

3. Delete all lines or rename the file to

```
user.script.bak
```

4. Save the blank file

Mod Installation (Steam Workshop)

1. Open the **Total War: SHOGUN 2** Workshop on Steam
2. For each mod listed in 02-mods.typ, click **Subscribe**
3. Steam will download the

```
.pack
```

files to your data directory

4. Launch the game — the launcher will show available mods

Configuring Load Order in user.script.txt

After subscribing to all Wave 1 mods:

1. Launch the game once via the launcher (this auto-generates

```
user.script.txt
```

)

2. **Alternatively:** manually create/edit

```
user.script.txt
```

in

```
%appdata%/The Creative Assembly/Shogun2/scripts/
```

3. Each line should read:

```
mod "filename.pack";
```

4. Mods load top-to-bottom — later entries override earlier ones.
5. Save the file.

Wave 1 Load Order

NOTE: Specific mods TBD. Load order template will be filled when mods are selected.

Starting a New Campaign

From the main menu:

1. Select **Single Player** → **New Campaign**
2. Select the **Oda** clan
3. Difficulty: **Hard** (you have experience now — time to earn it)
4. Campaign length: **Long**
5. Enable the following mod-launcher checkboxes if available: *TBD*
6. Click **Start**

Verifying Mods Are Active

In-game indicators that mods are loaded:

- Different loading screen art
- New units visible in recruitment menu
- Faction-specific visual changes
- If nothing looks different, check

```
user.script.txt
```

and that pack files exist in the data directory

Wave 1: Mod List

Wave 1 adds graphics enhancements, new unit packs, and faction expansions. No total overhauls — the game remains recognizable.

Graphics Enhancements

Entries pending.

Unit Packs

Entries pending.

Faction Expansions

Entries pending.

Compatibility Notes

All Wave 1 mods are selected for mutual compatibility. If you experience crashes, verify:

1. Load order matches 01-setup.typ
2. No Wave 2 mods are accidentally subscribed
3. No mod from Wave 0 that conflicts is still active

Strategy & Tactics: Intermediate

This guide assumes you completed a campaign on Normal. Here we cover army composition, battle tactics, agents, trade, and how to survive until Realm Divide.

Phase 2: Military Mastery

Army Composition by Era

Your army changes as the game progresses. Do not use the same army at turn 10 and turn 60.

Early game (turns 1-20, castle tiers 1-2): 8 yari ashigaru (anvil), 4 bow ashigaru (support), 2 yari cavalry (flank), 1 general. This costs roughly 1,000-1,200 koku per turn. Do not deviate from this. You cannot afford samurai.

Mid game (turns 20-50, castle tier 3): 4 yari ashigaru (keep them for yari wall), 4 katana samurai (the new anvil once lines are pinned), 2-3 naginata samurai (anti-cavalry reserve), 4 bow samurai (replaces bow ashigaru), 4 cavalry (2 yari + 2 katana cavalry), 1 general. Costs roughly 2,500-3,500 koku per turn. Replace units as they die, not all at once.

Late game (turns 50+, castle tier 4): 2 yari ashigaru (still useful for yari wall), 6 katana samurai, 4 naginata samurai, 2 matchlock ashigaru or samurai, 4 bow samurai, 4 katana cavalry, 1 general. Costs 5,000+ koku per turn. At this point you should have 3-4 such armies.

The Unit Triangle: Exact Mechanics

Every unit in Shogun 2 has three stats that determine matchups:

Melee attack: The chance to land a hit per swing. Katana samurai: 12-14. Yari ashigaru: 4-6. A katana samurai hits twice as often as an ashigaru.

Melee defense: The chance to block an incoming hit. Yari ashigaru in yari wall: +4 bonus (total 8-10). Katana samurai: 10-12. Naginata: 14-16 (best defensive unit in the game).

Charge bonus: Added to melee attack on the first hit after a charge. Cavalry: 15-25. Katana samurai: 5-8. This is why cavalry must charge in and pull out — the bonus only applies on the first hit, then degrades.

The rock-paper-scissors:

- **Yari beat cavalry** because yari wall gives +15 bonus vs cavalry charge and negates the enemy's charge bonus entirely. A cavalry unit charging yari wall attacks at its base melee attack (10-12) against the yari's melee defense (8-10) plus the +15 wall bonus — the cavalry cannot hit reliably while the yari chews them up.
- **Katana beat yari** because katana samurai have 2x the melee attack of yari ashigaru and high armor (6-8 vs yari's 2-3). They cut through the yari's defense faster than the yari can retaliate.
- **Cavalry beat ranged and flank** because ranged units have zero melee defense and cannot fight back. A cavalry charge into the rear of any unit adds a -8 morale penalty and negates shields, making the charge 3x more effective than a frontal charge.

Matchlock Units: Timing and Line of Sight

Matchlock ashigaru and samurai (available at castle tier 3-4 with the gunpowder tech researched) are the most powerful ranged units in the game IF you use them correctly.

- Matchlocks have a flat trajectory. They cannot shoot over your own infantry. You must create gaps in your front line for matchlocks to shoot through, or position them on a flank.

- Matchlocks have extremely long reload time. One volley every 20-30 seconds. Make each volley count.
- Matchlocks cause morale shock. A unit hit by a matchlock volley takes a -2 to -4 morale penalty on top of casualties. Two volleys into the same unit will cause it to waver.
- Matchlocks are useless in rain. Rain reduces their accuracy by 80%. Check the weather overlay before deploying.

To use matchlocks effectively: deploy your yari line in a shallow formation (2 ranks wide), place matchlocks 10-15 units behind the gaps between yari units. The matchlocks shoot through the gaps. When the enemy infantry reaches your line, order your matchlocks to flank and shoot into the enemy's flank — they will not hit your own troops this way.

Advanced Battle Tactics

Hammer and Anvil (standard):

1. Yari advances and engages the enemy line. Formation: yari wall, 4 ranks deep.
2. Cavalry moves wide — outside the enemy's line of sight if possible (use forests, hills).
3. Cavalry charges the rear of an engaged enemy unit. The target routes almost instantly.
4. The routing unit causes nearby enemies to check morale. Often 2-3 more units rout.
5. Repeat until the entire enemy line breaks.

Defense in Depth (outnumbered):

1. Deploy on a hill. High ground gives a combat bonus (roughly +2 melee attack to the uphill side).
2. Place yari at the hill's crest, bows on the reverse slope. Enemy bow units cannot shoot what they cannot see.
3. When the enemy charges uphill, they arrive exhausted (fatigue penalty). Exhausted units fight at 50% effectiveness.
4. Counter-charge downhill with cavalry for maximum charge bonus.

The Feigned Retreat (advanced, multiplayer-proven):

1. Select a cheap unit (yari ashigaru) and order them to retreat through a gap in your line.
2. The enemy AI often pursues the retreating unit, breaking their formation.
3. Hit the exposed enemy flank with your cavalry or katana reserve.

Agent Operations: Skill Trees and Strategy

– Metsuke –

Metsuke are your economic backbone. Every metsuke should specialize:

Economic metsuke (primary):

- Skill: Strengthen Town (every turn in your wealthiest province)
- Skill: Oversight (passive tax bonus in the province)
- Skill: Crackdown (suppress enemy agents)
- Promotion path: stay in one province until rank 4, then rotate to the next wealthiest
- A rank-4 economic metsuke adds roughly 30-50% to a province's tax output

Enforcement metsuke (secondary):

- Skill: Arrest (remove enemy ninja and monks)
- Skill: Investigate (find enemy agents)
- Counter-agent role. Place in provinces with high enemy agent activity.
- Can also be embedded in armies to root out enemy agents on the campaign map

Oversight metsuke (tertiary — late game):

- Skill: Oversight (all levels)
- Station in military recruitment provinces. Reduces recruitment cost and time.
- A rank-3 oversight metsuke can reduce recruitment costs by 20%.

– Ninja –

Ninja are your offensive arm. Each ninja should have ONE primary role:

Assassination ninja:

- Skills: Way of the Wind (movement), Shadow (assassination chance), Silent Strike (bonus vs generals)
- Target: enemy generals (removes the army's morale anchor), enemy metsuke (opening their provinces), enemy monks
- Never use your assassination ninja for sabotage — they level slower on sabotage XP

Sabotage ninja:

- Skills: Sabotage (buildings), Arson (castle damage), Way of the Earth (survival)
- Target: enemy recruitment buildings (prevents new units), castle walls (reduces siege defense)
- A high-rank sabotage ninja can destroy a castle's walls in one turn, making siege assault trivial

Scout ninja:

- Skills: Way of the Wind (movement), Way of Water (rivers), Eyes of the Lord (visibility)
- Use: keep ahead of your main army, scout enemy army composition, detect ambushes
- Place in forests near expected enemy approach routes

– Monks –

Monks handle religion and morale. Every province has a religion split between Shinto and Buddhism (plus Christianity if you convert).

Religious conversion (primary):

- Your starting clan has a state religion (Shimazu: Shinto, Oda: Shinto, Tokugawa: Shinto).
- Provinces with your state religion get +3-5 happiness.
- Provinces with opposing religions stack penalties: -3 per non-state religion present.
- A province with Shinto 80% and Buddhism 20% has Buddhism at 20%: -3 happiness.
- Use your monk's Convert action each turn in provinces with the wrong religion.

Warrior monk (combat embed):

- Skills: Warrior (melee attack), Inspiration (morale boost to nearby units), Levies (recruit monk units)
- Embed in your main army. The Inspiration aura adds +4 morale to nearby units.
- Monks can also recruit Warrior Monk units — some of the best infantry in the game (high attack, high morale, causes fear).
- A rank-3 Warrior Monk embedded in an army turns a standard army into an elite force.

Inciter (offensive):

- Skills: Incite Revolt (reduces happiness in target province), Insurrection (triggers a rebel army)
- Use: target a province you plan to attack. Incite revolt reduces the garrison's morale. If a rebel army spawns, it fights the garrison — your army arrives afterward to mop up.

Trade and Diplomacy

– Trade Nodes –

There are four offshore trade nodes on the naval map. Each provides trade goods worth 500-1,500 koku per turn depending on the node. Sending a trade ship to a node establishes a trade route. The ship auto-returns income each turn.

- Control of trade nodes is the difference between a struggling economy and a booming one.
- Each trade node can support 4 trade ships from your faction.
- Enemy clan trade nodes can be attacked. Sinking a trade ship does not declare war; blockading a node does.
- The Black Ship (Portuguese, appears near Kyushu in late game) is not a trade node but a unique ship. Capture it by boarding — it dominates any naval engagement for the rest of the game.

– Diplomacy Mechanics –

Diplomacy operates on a hidden relationship score (-200 to +200). Every action modifies this score:

Positive actions: honoring alliances (+30), giving gifts (+5 per 1,000 koku), marrying a daughter (+20), granting military access (+15), liberating captured provinces (+40 to the liberated clan)

Negative actions: breaking alliances (-40), refuse alliance request (-10), attacking allies (-80), trespassing (-5 per turn), territory expansion near their borders (-2 per province per turn)

Marriage: Marrying a daughter to another clan's daimyo creates an alliance that lasts 15-25 turns. After that, the alliance may break. Marriage does not prevent war — it delays it. Use marriage to secure one border while expanding on the other.

Alliance strategy: Never have more than 2 active alliances. Each alliance reduces the Realm Divide trigger threshold by roughly 2 provinces. Having 4 alliances means Realm Divide triggers at 18 provinces instead of 25.

Wave 1 Progression (Oda Clan)

1. **Turns 1-15:** Unify Owari province. Build farms and markets. Recruit ashigaru core. Do NOT attack the Ikko-Ikki early — they have high happiness and multiple stacks.
2. **Turns 15-30:** Expand east toward Kyoto. Take one province per 4 turns. Use marriage to keep the western clans (Mori, Otomo) neutral.
3. **Turns 30-50:** Capture Kyoto. The shogunate will be angry. Do not let yourself become Shogun yet — wait until you have 4 full armies.
4. **Turns 50-80:** Expand west and north simultaneously. Fortify Kyoto. Build trading ports and claim the western trade nodes.
5. **Turns 80+:** Realm Divide should trigger at 25 provinces. You want 4 full armies, 20,000+ koku, and strong garrisons on all borders before this happens.

Wave 2: Sekigahara's Shadow

Installation & Setup

Wave 2 introduces campaign overhauls, expanded mechanics, and deeper systems. This is the definitive Tenka Fubu experience. You must have completed at least one campaign on Hard difficulty.

Pre-Installation Cleanup

1. Open

```
%appdata%/The Creative Assembly/Shogun2/scripts/user.script.txt
```

2. Back up your Wave 1 configuration: save a copy as

```
user.script.wave1.bak
```

3. Clear the file for a fresh Wave 2 load order

Mod Installation

Follow the same procedure as Wave 1 (Steam Workshop subscription). For any mods hosted on Total War Center:

1. Download the

```
.pack
```

file(s) from the provided link

2. Place them in

```
steamapps/common/Total War Shogun 2/data/
```

3. Add the filename to

```
user.script.txt
```

in the correct position

Wave 2 Load Order

NOTE: Specific mods TBD. Load order template will be filled when mods are selected.

General principles for Wave 2 load order:

- **Gameplay overhauls first** (foundational changes to mechanics)
- **Expanded maps/map modifications second**
- **Unit packs third** (these override unit tables)
- **Visual/graphics mods last** (least likely to conflict)

Starting a New Campaign

1. Select **Single Player** → **New Campaign**
2. Select the **Tokugawa** clan
3. Difficulty: **Hard** or **Very Hard**
4. Campaign length: **Long**
5. Click **Start**

Troubleshooting Wave 2 Conflicts

If the game crashes on launch or campaign start:

1. Disable mods one at a time to isolate the conflict
2. Check

```
conflicts.md
```

for known incompatibilities

3. Verify every mod's Workshop page for update status
4. Post in the Tenka Fubu discussion thread if stuck

Wave 2: Mod List

Wave 2 introduces campaign overhauls, expanded maps, and deeper mechanics. These mods significantly change how the game plays.

Campaign Overhauls

Entries pending.

Expanded Map / Mechanics

Entries pending.

AI & Difficulty Mods

Entries pending.

Compatibility Notes

Wave 2 mods have the highest potential for conflicts. Always:

1. Read the full Workshop description for known incompatibilities
2. Check the last-updated date
3. Review recent comments before subscribing
4. Test with a new campaign (not a saved game) after changing load order

Advanced Play: Expert Mechanics

Phase 3: Realm Divide & High-Level Strategy

How Realm Divide Actually Works

Realm Divide is not a fixed threshold. It is a hidden **fame** score that accumulates from everything you do:

- Owning provinces: +2 fame per province above 20
- Becoming Shogun (holding Kyoto for 4 consecutive turns): +40 fame
- Destroying a major clan (eliminating every member): +15 fame
- Winning heroic victories: +2-5 fame per battle
- Alliances: -2 fame per alliance (alliances delay the Divide, they do not eliminate it)

When your fame score reaches 75 (on Normal), Realm Divide triggers. On Hard the threshold is 65. On Very Hard it is 55.

The turn Realm Divide triggers, every surviving clan that has no treaties with you automatically declares war. Clans that have active treaties (non-aggression, trade, alliance) get a choice — they may join you, stay neutral, or join the coalition against you. Most will join against you.

The only way to prevent Realm Divide is to never reach the fame threshold. This means staying below 22 provinces (the safe zone) or avoiding heroic victories. Since you must reach 25+ provinces for a Short Campaign victory, Realm Divide is mandatory for completing the game.

Pre-Divide Preparation (Turns 10-20 Before)

Start preparing 10-20 turns before you expect Realm Divide. The timing is predictable if you count provinces: divide triggers 1-3 turns after you cross 25 provinces.

Military preparation:

- Every border province gets a castle upgrade (minimum tier 3). A tier-3 castle has walls, oil, and a garrison of 8 units. The AI will waste 3-5 turns besieging each one.
- Every army should be at 18-20 units. Do not have partial stacks when Divide triggers.
- Station one full army at each border region. You need 1 army per 3-4 border provinces.
- Your main army (the best general, the best units) stays in a central position where it can reinforce any border within 2 turns.

Economic preparation:

- Stockpile 20,000-30,000 koku. You will not be able to trade after Divide triggers.
- All provinces that can build a market should build a market. Your peacetime economy must support wartime spending.
- Build roads on all border provinces. Faster army movement means you can defend twice as many provinces with the same number of armies.

Diplomatic preparation:

- Break all alliances 5-10 turns before you expect Divide. Each broken alliance costs -10 honor, but a clan that is neutral toward you has a small chance of staying neutral during Divide. A clan that is allied when Divide triggers gets a massive diplomacy penalty — they almost always join the coalition.
- Leave 1-2 non-aggression pacts active. These give a small chance the clan stays neutral.
- Give small gifts (1,000 koku) to your most powerful neighbors. This improves their relationship score, making them slightly more likely to stay neutral.

Post-Divide Strategy: The First 10 Turns

The first 10 turns after Realm Divide determine whether you survive. The AI has a massive military advantage at this point — every clan in Japan has full armies and they all target you.

Turn 1-3 (the initial wave):

- Do not advance anywhere. Pull back all armies to defensive positions.
- Every army should be inside a castle or on a river crossing with a hill behind it.
- Use your navy to blockade the 2-3 most active enemy ports. A blockaded port cannot produce new units.
- Spend your stockpiled koku: recruit emergency garrisons in provinces without castles. A single yari ashigaru unit adds +3 happiness and +1 garrison.

Turn 4-7 (the first cracks):

- The AI will attack your best-defended positions first. Let them. Fight every siege defense manually.
- Siege defense is the most lopsided battle in Shogun 2. A garrison of 8 yari ashigaru can defeat 2 full stacks if you fight manually. The defender gets: wall combat bonus, unlimited ammunition for bow units, oil at the gates (kills 100+ models per pour), and reduced fatigue from not moving.
- Pick the weakest enemy army and destroy it with your central reserve. A full stack elimination (-20 units) reduces the total enemy strength significantly. Most AI clans will struggle to replace 20 units quickly.

Turn 8-10 (stabilization):

- The initial AI rush will slow as their armies are depleted.
- Now you counter-attack. Take one strategic province (a trade node, a choke point, or an enemy capital).
- Do not advance beyond one province. Consolidate, repair walls, recruit.

The Siege Timing Formula

Siege offense is the hardest skill in Shogun 2. Here is the exact timing:

1. Arrive at the enemy castle. Build 2 siege towers. This takes 2 turns.
2. Attack on the turn the towers complete. The AI repairs broken walls between turns — do not give them that turn.
3. Deploy both towers on the same wall section. Concentrating your force beats spreading it out.
4. Send 2 units up each tower. While they fight on the walls, send a ram unit to the gate.
5. Once the gate breaks (2-3 turns of ramming), send your cavalry and general through.
6. Capture the center. The battle ends when you hold the center for 60 seconds — you do not need to kill every defender.

Starvation (besieging without attacking): a castle with a full garrison holds 4-6 turns of food on Normal difficulty. After food runs out, the garrison takes 20% casualties per turn. On turn 4 of starvation, the garrison is at 50% strength. Starving is safer than assaulting but gives the enemy time to reinforce. Only starve tier-4 castles (Citadel+) where assaulting would cost too many lives.

Navy Dominance

Naval power is the most overlooked mechanic by intermediate players. Here is how it works:

Ship types:

- **Bow Kobaya:** Fast, cheap, 15 crew. Use for scouting and trade node occupation.
- **Bow Medium:** 40 crew, 10 bowmen. Your standard fighting ship. Can blockade ports.
- **Wako (Rise of the Samurai):** Heaviest normal ship. Very effective in boarding actions.
- **Black Ship:** Unique Portuguese carrack. 60 crew, 20 cannon (refire). One-shots any other ship. Captured via boarding — reduce crew to 30 via cannon fire, then board. Once yours, it wins every naval battle automatically.

Blockade mechanics: A blockaded port cannot recruit ships. A blockaded port generates 50% less tax income. Blockading a clan's only port cuts their naval capacity to zero. Blockade is not an act of war in itself — but the targeted clan will dislike you.

Transport interdiction: Enemy armies at sea on transport ships are the most vulnerable target in the game. A single bow medium ship can sink a transport carrying 20 units. The army is destroyed (only the general survives in most cases). This is the most efficient way to reduce enemy strength — one ship costing 300 koku destroys 20 units worth 5,000+ koku.

Trade node strategy: Never leave a trade node undefended. The AI will try to capture it. Park 2 bow medium ships at each node you control. When an enemy approaches, attack before they reach the node.

Agent Synergies at Scale

Deep into a campaign, you should have 4-5 agents of each type. Coordinate them:

Province disruption chain:

1. Monk: Incite Revolt in target province (reduces happiness by -10 over 3 turns)
2. Ninja: Sabotage Castle Walls (reduces wall HP by 50%)
3. Ninja: Assassinate General (if an army is in the province)
4. Army: Attack with full stack
5. Metsuke: Capture Town (prevents revolt for 3 turns after conquest)

This chain lets one army conquer a tier-4 province with 80% fewer casualties than a direct assault.

The three-agent scout:

1. Ninja (Way of the Wind, max movement skills) moves ahead of the army
2. When the ninja spots an enemy stack, a second ninja (assassination spec) targets the general
3. If the assassination fails, the metsuke (crackdown spec) moves in to arrest any enemy counter-agents

Phase 4: Mastery & Mod Integration

Advanced Province Specialization with Math

The difference between an average player and an expert player is province specialization.

Compound growth calculation: A province developed starting at turn 10 versus turn 50:

- Turn 10 start: 40 turns of compound growth $\times$ 3% per turn = $3.3\times$ baseline wealth
- Turn 50 start: 0 turns of compound growth (war starts soon after) = $1\times$ baseline wealth

This is why developing economy early, even when it feels like you should be recruiting armies, is always correct. One farm built at turn 5 pays for itself by turn 15 and generates pure profit from turn 15-80.

Ideal province grid:

- **Kyoto:** Economic capital. All market slots, metsuke stationed permanently. Towers generate +50% trade income.
- **Your home province:** Military capital. Max castle, all recruitment buildings, armor smith, horse dojo. Produces units in 1 turn.
- **Coastal provinces:** Port + market in every coastal slot. Trade nodes, navy recruitment.
- **Inland farms:** 3-4 farms + road. Nothing else. These are food-only provinces that feed your military provinces.
- **Border provinces:** Castle + road + 1 farm. These are forts — their economic output is secondary to their defensive value.

The Four Army Doctrine

In the late game, organize your armies into four distinct types:

Sweeper army: 14 yari ashigaru, 4 bow ashigaru, 1 general, 1 metsuke. Purpose: capture undefended provinces and serve as emergency garrison. Each unit costs 200-300 koku. A full stack costs 5,000 koku and can be recruited in 2 turns. Use 2-3 sweeper armies to occupy territory faster than the enemy can react.

Strike army: 4 yari, 6 katana, 4 naginata, 2 matchlock, 2 bow, 2 cavalry. Purpose: destroy enemy main forces. This army costs 12,000 koku and takes 5+ turns to recruit. You want 1-2 of these.

Siege army: 6 yari, 2 naginata, 4 matchlock, 6 bow, 2 cavalry. Purpose: capture high-tier castles. Extra ranged units for wall suppression. General has the **Engineer** retinue (faster siege construction).

Naval army: 6 bow medium ships, 2 Wako/Black Ship. Purpose: control the seas, blockade ports, interdict transports. A naval army costs 3,000 koku and takes 3 turns to recruit.

Opening Moves for Hard Clan Campaigns

After completing a campaign as a strong clan (Shimazu, Oda, Tokugawa), try these:

Imagawa (Very Hard start):

- You are sandwiched between Oda to the east and Tokugawa to the west.
- Turn 1: Send a gift of 1,000 koku to Oda. Build a farm. Recruit yari ashigaru.
- Turn 2: Move your army toward Tokugawa. Attack them before they attack you.
- Turns 3-20: Fight a defensive war against Oda while conquering Tokugawa territory. Do not let Oda catch you in the open — fight from castles.
- Key advantage: Imagawa gets +2 honor from trade. Use trade as your economy engine.

Mori (naval focus):

- You control the western trade nodes. Build trade ships on turn 1 and send them to the nearest node.
- Your economy comes from the sea, not the land. You can afford fewer armies but better ones.
- Key advantage: Mori bow ships are the best in the game. Dominate the seas, blockade your enemies, and starve their economies.

Hojo (development focus):

- You start in the Kanto region (eastern Japan) with the highest development potential in the game.
- Build farms and markets in every province for the first 20 turns. Do not recruit more than one army.

- Key advantage: Hojo get +1 to castle tiers. Your castles are always one level above everyone else's. A Hojo tier-3 castle is effectively a tier-4 castle.

Realm Divide: The Minimal Province Strategy

The most advanced Realm Divide strategy is to deliberately delay it:

1. Stay below 22 provinces. Never cross the threshold.
2. Raze (sack + abandon) provinces beyond 22 instead of occupying them.
3. Build 3-4 fully-developed core provinces with max-tier farms, markets, and castles.
4. Build 4 full strike armies.
5. In one turn: occupy 5-10 razed provinces (they cost nothing militarily — no garrisons).
6. Realm Divide triggers. You now have 30+ provinces and 4 full armies.
7. The initial AI wave hits your well-fortified core provinces and breaks against them.
8. Counter-attack with your strike armies while the AI is recovering from their failed offensive.

This strategy requires discipline. Every time you see an undefended province and want to take it, ask: **Is this province worth triggering Realm Divide over?** If the answer is no, raze it.

Moving Beyond

After completing this curriculum, you have mastered Total War: SHOGUN 2. The game opens into new challenges:

- **Multiplayer:** The competitive scene on Steam uses house rules (no matchlock spam, no cavalry doomstacks). Join the Shogun 2 discord for organized matches.
- **Modding:** Use the Assembly Kit (free on Steam) to create custom units, factions, and campaign maps. The TWC modding forums have tutorials.
- **Legendary difficulty:** No manual saves, no pausing, the AI gets maximum bonuses. Complete a Legendary campaign as every clan.

Quick Reference — Recommended Learning Path

Stage	Clan	Difficulty	Focus	Mod Intensity
Tutorial	—	Normal	Controls & basics	None / Light
Early Campaign	Date / Shimazu	Normal	Economy + Army building	Light
Military Focus	Takeda / Oda	Normal–Hard	Battles & Composition	Medium
Realm Divide	Any	Hard	Strategy & Pressure management	Medium–Full
Mastery	Weak clans	Hard–Very Hard	Full systems + Mods	Full Tenka Fubu